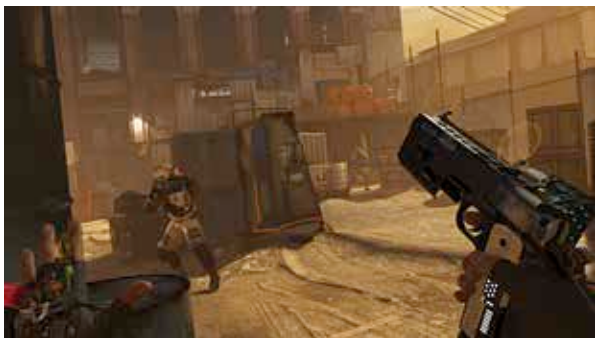




more developers will start considering it. When it comes to games, certain genres could, and already do, benefit from VR. Specifically racing and flight simulator games like Gran Turismo which utilised PSVR, and Microsoft Flight Simulator which puts you directly in the cockpit.

VR accessories, like haptic gloves and full body suits further serve to improve the overall immersive experience, allowing you to physically feel and experience the worlds of the games you're playing. However, there are still some problems that need working around. While RPG and Action-Adventure games, basically games that already have first-person views, are easier to adapt to VR, sports games like FIFA, and RTS games, where a first-person per-



spective wouldn't necessarily work, still need a solution. Additionally, while this is subjective, playing a VR game while sitting on a couch can be immersion breaking to some people. Sure you can use the controllers to move around, but again, it's a question of immersion. Certain VR games require a lot of moving around, and unless you're okay with using the joysticks to move, you would need to readily have a large enough space

available in order to enjoy these games. Accessories to be able to run and walk in place do exist, including the kind that have haptic feedback of their own, but they're still new and cost a bomb as it stands right now.

THE FUTURE AND WHAT YOU CAN GET NOW

The kind of VR seen in Sword Art Online is a pipe dream. VR headsets are not going to be putting us in a



trance-like state and transporting us to game worlds where we have full motor controls and all five sensations. However, the kind of VR we've seen in Ready Player One could certainly be something VR could work towards. We're still a long way away from it though. Widespread adoption, improved hardware and technology, solving space constraints, etc are just a few of things that need to be addressed to make that a reality. However, if you want to dive into VR gaming right now, these VR headsets are your best bet.

Sony PlayStation VR

If you've got a PlayStation, then you can't go wrong with the Sony PSVR. Everyone knows Sony makes excellent exclusive content, and the Sony PSVR is no exception. It will however



set you back by around ₹38,000, which is not including the cost of the PlayStation 4 or 5 console itself.

Valve Index

The Valve Index is an excellent VR headset, unfortunately it's not available in India yet. If you're really



desperate to get your hands on one, it'll set you back by around 2 lacs. The Index features revolutionary finger-tracking controllers, which is the best you can get your hands on right now.

HTC Vive Pro 2

The Vive Pro 2 is an excellent high-res VR headset, and will probably give you the best visual experience possible on a commercial VR headset.



It'll set you back by around 1 lac, possibly more. It's also easy to set up for PC and Steam users.

Oculus Quest 2

The Oculus Quest 2 is an overall improved version of the Oculus Quest, at a cheaper price point, making it the most accessible VR



headset out there for PC VR gamers. Furthermore, it's wireless! Not needing to worry about a cable to trip on and wrapping around your foot is a big plus. You can pick the Quest 2 up for around ₹40,000. 